

89. According to the report of IIT Kharagpur study group, continuous low rainfall for how many years was the cause of fall of the Indus valley civilization?

- (a) 600 years (b) 700 years
(c) 800 years (d) 900 years
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

According to the reports of IIT Kharagpur, the continuous low or negligible rainfall for 900 years was the cause of fall of the Indus Valley Civilisation. In other words, it can be said that continuous drought for 900 years led the fall of Indus Valley Civilisation.

90. A horned deity engraved on a terracotta cake has been recovered from

- (a) Banawali (b) Kalibangan
(c) Lothal (d) Surkotada

U.P. Lower Spl. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

From excavations at Kalibangan, a series of 'fire altars' on mud-brick platforms were discovered. A triangular terracotta cake found at Kalibangan had a carving of a horned deity on one side and an animal (goat) being dragged by a rope by a human on the other. This shows the way to the emergence of a sacrificial tradition in the entire era.

91. Which of the following civilizations flourished on the bank of River Nile ?

- (a) Roman Civilization
(b) Indus Valley Civilization
(c) Greek Civilization
(d) Egyptian Civilization

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

Ancient Egyptian Civilization flourished along the banks of the River Nile for almost 3,000 years. Nile River is known as the 'lifeline of Egypt.' The Nile is a major north-flowing river in northeastern Africa, generally regarded as the longest river in the world. Indus Valley Civilization (India) and Mesopotamia (Iraq) are the contemporary civilizations.

92. What is the correct North-South sequence of the following civilizations?

- (a) Maya – Aztec – Muisca – Inca
(b) Maya – Muisca – Inca – Aztec
(c) Aztec – Muisca – Maya – Inca
(d) Aztec – Maya – Muisca – Inca

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The correct sequence of the following civilizations from North to South is: Aztec - Maya- Muisca - Inca. The expansion of Aztec civilization was on the Northern Part of

Mesoamerica. Mesoamerica included the Region from central Mexico, Belize, Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua and Northern Costa Rica. Mayan civilization was spread over the southern part of Mesoamerica. Moisca civilization was distributed in the eastern part of Columbia (South America continent), whereas Inca civilization is spread in the western part of southern America till the north of Quito and Santiago to the South.

93. The oldest civilization in the world is

- (a) Indus valley (b) Chinese
(c) Egyptian (d) Mesopotamia (Iraq)

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (d)

The Mesopotamian civilization is considered the world's oldest civilization. This civilization developed in present-day Iraq and the surrounding areas. The Egyptian civilization (the civilization of the Nile) developed in the Nile River basin and is considered to have emerged after the Mesopotamian civilization.

94. The first ancient civilization to develop the art of writing in a proper system was?

- (a) Indus (b) Egypt
(c) Sumerian (d) China

R.A.S. / R.T.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

People of the Sumerian Civilization were the first to develop the art of writing in a proper system. Their primary script was very simple and primitive. Cuneiform script of Sumeria is generally known as one of the earliest systems of writing.

Vedic Age

*The word 'Vedic' is derived from the Sanskrit word 'Veda' which means knowledge. The civilization that developed in India after Indus Valley civilization is called Vedic or Aryan Civilization. *Arya means **Great** or **highborn**. In classic Sanskrit, the word Arya means – '**A noble man**'. The history of Aryans is mainly known from the Vedas. Generally, Aryans are said to be the authors of the Vedas. There is a difference of opinion on the place of origin of Aryans. Prominent historians have different theories on the homeland of Aryans.

Homeland of Aryans	Scholars
Kashmir or Himalayan region	L.D. Kalla
Brahmarshi Desh	P. Ganganath Jha
Seven Indus states	Dr. Avinash Chandra Das
Devika State	D.S. Trivedi
South Russia	Gorden Childe & Nehring
Central Asia	Max Muller
North Pole	Pt. Bal Gangadhar Tilak
Tibet	Swami Dayanand Saraswati
Valley of Danube River	Gyles
Germany	Hart & Penca

*The Vedic Age is divided into two parts – Rigvedic or Pre-Vedic Age (1500-1000 BCE) and Later-Vedic Age (1000-600 BCE). *Each of the Vedas is divided into four parts (or the sections). Their correct order is **Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas** and **Upanishads**. *Samhitas and Brahmanas form the Karma-Kanda segment of the Vedas. ***Aranyakas** and **Upanishads** form the Gyan-Kanda segment of the Vedas. They explicitly focus on philosophy and spirituality. *The history of the Rigvedic age is known from Rigveda. It is the oldest known book in the world but scholars have disputes over its author and period of composition. ***Iron** is not mentioned in Rigveda but is found in later Vedic literature. *Four rivers of Afghanistan namely **Krumu, Kubha, Gomati** and **Suvastu** are mentioned in Rigveda. *It also mentions seven rivers of the Sapta-Sindhu states (land of seven rivers). These are **Saraswati, Vipasa, Parushni, Vitasta, Sindhu** (Indus), **Shutudri** and **Asakini**. River Yamuna and Ganga are mentioned in Rigveda three and one times respectively. *A river of Kashmir Marudvridha is also mentioned. *River Indus is mentioned the most number of times while river Saraswati was the **most sacred river** which was known as '**Matetama**' (best of all mothers), '**Devitama**' (best of all goddesses) and '**Naditama**' (best of all rivers). *Indus is called '**Hiranyayi**' for its importance and it falls in the Arabian Sea. *Ganga-Yamuna doab and its adjoining areas were called **Brahmarshi Desh** by Aryans. They gave the name **Madhya Desh** to the area between Himalaya and Vindhya mountain ranges. Later Aryans expanded themselves to the whole of North India and the area came to be known as **Aryavarta**.

Rivers of Rigvedic Age –

Ancient Name	Modern Name
Asakini	Chenab
Vipasa	Beas
Parushni	Ravi
Vitasta	Jhelum
Kubha	Kabul
Krumu	Kurram
Gomati	Gomal
Suvastu	Swat
Sadaneera	Gandak
Shutudri	Sutlej
Drishdvati	Ghaggar

*Vedic literature is also called **Shruti**. The Vedas are the most ancient literature in India. There are four Vedas- **Rigveda, Samaveda, Yajurveda** and **Atharvaveda**. *Rigveda, Yajurveda and Samaveda are also called **Vedtrayi** or **Trayi**. *Each Ved has four parts – Samhita, Brahmana, Aranyakas and Upanishad. *Rigveda has **10** mandals, **1028** suktas and 10552 verses (Richas). **2 to 7** mandals of Rigveda are known to be most ancient.

Rigvedic Mandals and their writers –

Mandals	Writers
First	Maduchchanda, Medhatithi, etc.
Second	Gritasamada
Third	Vishvamitra
Fourth	Vamadeva
Fifth	Atri
Sixth	Bhardvaja
Seventh	Vashishtha
Eighth	Kanva & Angiras
Ninth	Angiras and many others
Tenth	Vimada, Indra, Shachi and many others

***Gayatri Mantra** is mentioned in the **third** Mandal. It is written by **Vishwamitra**. It is dedicated to Lord Savitra (Surya). *All **114** hymns in the ninth mandal are dedicated to '**Soma**'. *Three Varnas are described in the beginning namely – Brahman, Kshatriya and Vaishya. The Varna **Shudra** is mentioned for the first time in the **Purush Sukta** of **10th** Mandal. *The priests of Rigveda were called '**Hota**'. ***Aitreya** and **Kaushitki** are the two Brahmanas of Rigveda. *According to **Patanjali**, there are 21 branches of Rigveda.

***Yajurveda** in Sanskrit means 'Wisdom of sacrificial formulas.' This Veda compiled a century or two after the Rig-Veda, contains prose and verse formulas that were to be pronounced by the priests performing the manual part of the sacrifice. It describes in prose about the procedural details of performing different rituals and Yajnas using the hymns of the Rig Veda. The Samhitas of Yajurveda are divided into two parts: **Shukla (White) Yajurveda** and **Krishna (Black) Yajurveda**. Shukla Yajurveda has a separate Brahmana text written as **Shatpatha Brahmana**. ***Vajasneyi** is the samhita of Shukla Yajurveda. *Shukla Yajurveda is available only in the poetic form whereas Krishna Yajurveda contains both poetic as well as prose form. *The **Shatpatha Brahmana** is a prose text describing Vedic rituals, history and mythology associated with the Yajurveda. In context of Ancient Indian Vedic literature, Shatpatha Brahmana has been placed just after the Rigveda. It also describes social subjects including Vedic rituals. *'**Purushamedha**' has been mentioned in Shatpatha Brahmana. *The Shatpatha Brahmana narrates the story of King Videgha Madhava (a king of Videha) accompanied by his priest **Rishi Gautama Rahugana**. King was carrying fire (Agni Vaisvanara) in his mouth which on incitation of his guru fell out of his mouth and burned the earth towards his east.

*The **Samaveda** is the shortest among all the four Vedas. It is closely connected with the Rigveda. It has taken many verses from the Rigveda. The Samaveda is compiled for ritual application and all its verses are meant to be chanted in ceremonies. *Samaveda Samhita consists of a total of **1875** verses. Amongst these except 75 or 99 verses, all are compiled in Rigveda.

*Priest Chanting mantras were called **Brahma** in **Atharvaveda**. The first reference to the '**Anga**' and '**Magadha**' is found in the Atharvaveda where they are mentioned along with Gandhari and Mujavats. In the post-Vedic period, this region of Kuru & Panchala was considered the axis of Aryan culture because here great achievements happened in science, mathematics, astronomy, religion and philosophy. *'**Ayurveda**' that is 'Science of Life' appeared first in Atharvaveda. Ayurveda is an Upaveda of Atharvaveda. It is also considered as Upanga of Atharvaveda. Atharvaveda describes the thoughts and superstitions of common people. It comprises various contents such as disease prevention, coordination, loyalty, marriage and love poetry. *The **Gopatha Brahmana** is the only Brahmana associated with the Atharvaveda. It is a genre of the prose texts describing the Vedic rituals.

*The **Upanishad** literature is not a religious scripture but represents a philosophy for all times and for all. The philosophy of Upanishads does not oppose any school of thought, religion or interpretation of the scriptures but its method for explaining its concepts is unique. *The word salvation or Moksha is not used in Vedas. It was first discussed in the Upanishads. *Moksha means "liberation". The continuous cycle of life and death is not the actual aim of the human soul. *According to the Upanishads, **the core of our self is not the body or the mind but the Atman (Soul)**.

***Kathopanishad** is the story of the conversation between Yama, Lord of death and Nachiketa, the young 12 year old boy who left home in search of the meaning of death and beyond. This forms the subject matter of one of the Upanishads called Katha Upanishad or Kathopanishad.

*The phrase "**Satyameva Jayate**" is a Sanskrit word taken from the '**Mundakopanishad**'. The meaning of the word is "**Truth Alone Triumphs**." It was adopted as the **national motto of India**. It is inscribed in the script at the base of the national emblem. It was adopted by the Government of India on **26 January 1950**. ***Satyakama Jabala** is a boy and later a Vedic sage, who first appears in chapter IV of ancient Hindu text, the **Chhandogya Upanishad**. *The phrase "**Tamso Ma Jyotirgamaya**" is originally mentioned in Brihadaranyaka Upanishad. This phrase means - "**lead us from darkness to light or lead us from ignorance to truth**".

***Puranas** are the sacred literature of Hinduism. There are 18 Puranas namely- (1) Matsya Purana (2) Markandeya Purana (3) Bhagavat Purana (4) Bhavishya Purana (5) Brahmanda Purana (6) Brahma Vaivarta Purana (7) Brahma Purana (8) Vamana Purana (9) Varaha Purana (10) Vishnu Purana (11) Vayu Purana (12) Agni Purana (13) Narada Purana (14) Padma Purana (15) Linga Purana (16) Garuda Purana (17) Skanda Purana (18) Kurma Purana. *Out of these 18 Puranas, Srimad Bhagvatam is considered the 'Crown Jewel' of all the Vedic literature. ***Shrimad Bhagavad Gita** was originally written in Sanskrit language often referred to in short as Gita. ***Mahabharata** originally had only 8,800 Shlokas and its original name is '**Jaya**'

or **Jayasamhita**. *Mahabharata today has 100,000 Shlokas and is believed to be written by Sage **Veda Vyasa**. ***Puranas** have five characteristics like Sarga, Pratisarga, Vansa, Manvantara and Vanshanucharita. Among these, **Sarga** and **Pratisarga** are the natural creation and renovation (cosmogony). ***Vansa** means the history of Sage and God. ***Manvantara** is meant for the period of different Manus and Vanshanucharit means Genealogy of kings. *Pancha-Jana suggested five specific tribes whose eponymous ancestors were the founders of the clans, namely **Yadu, Turvasu, Druhyu, Anu** and **Puru**. *There is an ancient story mentioned in the Rigveda called the Dasharajnya war or '**Battle of 10 Kings**' long before Ramayana. There lived a descendant of India's eponymous king Bharata, named Sudas. The greatest achievement of Sudas was his thumping victory over a confederacy of ten kings.

*Many hymns of the Rigveda were composed by women and they were called **Brahmavadini**. The prominent among them were **Lopamudra, Vishwawara, Sikta, Ghosa etc.**

***Lopamudra** was the wife of Agastya Rishi/sage.

***Family** or **Kul** was the smallest unit of Rigvedic society.

*Rigvedic society was a **patriarchal society**. It is known from Varun Sukta that **a father can sell his child**. *The word '**Yava**' mentioned in Rigveda is used for the food grain **Barley**. The gold necklace was called '**Nishka**'.

Terms of Rigvedic period and their meaning –	
Vasa	Lower garment
Adhivasa	Upper garment
Taksha	Carpenter
Karma	Metal worker
Veknat	Moneylender
Aritri	Boatmen

*The religion of early Vedic Aryans was mainly related to the worship of the nature and performing of Yajnas. *The most interesting aspect of Rigvedic religion was its **polytheistic** character in which a number of Gods were worshipped. The Rigvedic Aryans worshipped nature with intense feeling and endowed it with an animated soul. Vedic Gods were mainly classified into three groups- (1) God of sky-Varuna, Mitra, Surya, Vishnu etc. (2) God of space- Indra, Rudra etc. (3) God of earth- Agni, Brihaspati, Soma etc. *'**Indra**' has been described as the most powerful deity in the Rigveda. 'Indra' is called **Purandara (Destroyer of forts)**. A very large number of Rigvedic hymns (as many as **250 hymns**) are devoted to him followed by '**Agni**' (200 hymns). ***Boghaz-Koi inscription** (Asia Minor, Turkiye) is important because there is mention of four Vedic Gods, namely-**Indra, Varuna, Mitra** and **Nasatya**. *According to ancient Hindu scriptures, during Vedic period, the 'Hindu' tradition recognized four stages or ashramas in human life namely **Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha** and **Sanyasa**. *In the context of ancient Indian society, Vansha,

Gotra and Kula are the words associated with the family system. The word '**Kosa**' is related to the treasury. *As a Rigvedic term, **Gotra** simply means "cow shelter" or "herd of cows".

***Cow** was considered "**Aghanya**" during the Vedic period. "Aghanya" means not worthy to be killed. This status of the cow shows that how pious it was considered during the Vedic period. ***Cattle breeding** was the most important economic activity of the Rigvedic people. Prayers were offered to increase the number of cattle. It was a medium of exchange. *Cow is considered as a deity in some suktas of Rigveda.

***Dharma** and **Rita** in the Vedic period appear as early as the Rigveda. Usually, Dharma signifies cosmic ordinance often in connection with the sense of natural or divine law. 'Rita' as such is closely related to universal harmony in which all things in the world have a proper place and function. *The concept of '**Rita**' i.e., universal principal of natural order, is of Vedic origin. The 'Rita' has been the basis of Indian culture, legal theory, politics and philosophy. ***God Varuna** was supposed to uphold 'Rita' or the natural order that is why he was also called as '**Ritasyagopa**'.

*The most popular and prevalent system of governance during the Vedic era was inherited monarchy. Although some examples of election by the people were also found but the general interest of the public was towards monarchy. *During the Vedic era, the two institutions namely '**Sabha**' and the '**Samiti**' have been mentioned as the controlling powers upon the autocracy of the king. *The 'Sabha' was the assembly of the learned and elite ones, while the 'Samiti' was the assembly of the common people in the state.

*The distinction between Sabha and Samiti cannot be made out with precision, but it is clear that 'Sabha' and 'Samiti' are clearly mentioned at least eight times and nine times respectively in the Rigveda. According to Atharvaveda, Sabha and Samiti are the **two daughters of Prajapati**.

Purohit	Advisor of king
Senani	Head of army
Gramani	Head of Village
Pattmahishi	Wife of king
Suta	Head of Chariot army
Sangrahita	Treasurer
Bhagdudh	Tax collector
Akshavap	Accountant
Palagal	Messenger
Kshata	Keeper of the King's household

*There are a total of sixteen **Sanskars** that have been described. The sixteen Sanskaras are as follows- **Garbhadhana** (Conception), **Punsavana** (Foetus protection), **Simantonnayana** (Satisfying the cravings of the pregnant mother), **Jatakarma** (Childbirth), **Namakaran** (Naming the child), **Nishkramana**

(Taking the child outdoors for the first time), **Annaprasana** (Giving solid food), **Chudakarma** (Hair cutting), **Karnavedha** (Ear piercing), **Vidhyarambha** (Starting education), **Upanayana** (Sacred thread ceremony), **Vedarambha** (Study of Vedas), **Keshant**, **Samavartana** (Returning home after completion of education), **Vivaha** (Marriage) and **Antyesthi** (Cremation).

Name of kings having territories in different directions –	
East	Samrat
West	Swarat
North	Virat
South	Bhoj
Centre	Raja

***Bal Gangadhar Tilak** in his book 'The Arctic Home in the Vedas' propounded the theory that North Pole (Arctic region) was the original home of Aryans. "Although this theory of Tilak is not acceptable to historians.

1. The term 'Aryan' denotes :

- (a) An ethnic group (b) A nomadic people
(c) A speech group (d) A superior race

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

'Aryan' is a term meaning 'noble' which was used as a self-designation by Indo-Iranian people. In classic Sanskrit, the word Arya means- 'A nobleman'. The word was used by the people of the Vedic period in India as an ethnic label for themselves as well as to refer noble class. Scholars point out that even in ancient times, the idea of being an 'Aryan' was religious, cultural and linguistic, not racial.

2. Meaning of the term 'Arya' in classical Sanskrit is

- (a) Believer of the God
(b) A hereditary caste
(c) A believer in particular religion
(d) A Noble man

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Which one of the following is oldest Veda :

- (a) Yajurveda (b) Rigveda
(c) Samaveda (d) Atharvaveda

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995
Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

In Indian literature, Vedas are the most ancient scriptures which are four in number, namely Rigveda, Yajurveda, Samaveda and Atharvaveda. Rigveda is the most important and oldest among all these.

4. Which among the following Vedas was the earliest composition?

- (a) Rigveda (b) Samaveda
(c) Yajurveda (d) Atharvaveda

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

5. 'Trayi' is a name for –

- (a) Three Vedas
(b) Dharma, Sangha and Buddha
(c) Three Gods in Hindu Pantheon
(d) Three seasons

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

Rigveda, Yajurveda and Samaveda are called Vedatrayi or simply Trayi.

6. In which Vedic text the term 'Varna' is found referred for the first time?

- (a) Rigveda (b) Atharvaveda
(c) Samaveda (d) Yajurveda

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

The 'Varnas' have been known from Rigveda since a hymn in the Rigveda portrays the Brahmin (Priest), the Kshatriya (noble), the Vaishya (commoner) and the Shudra (servant) issued forth at creation from the mouth, arms, thighs and the feet of the primeval person (Purusha). Although the literal meaning of the word Varna is colour or class (in Sanskrit).

7. The 'Purush Sukta' related to Varna System is originally found in –

- (a) Atharvaveda (b) Samaveda
(c) Rig Veda (d) Manusmriti
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

8. Match the following:

- | | |
|----------------|----------------------|
| A. Atharvaveda | 1. God Grace |
| B. Rigveda | 2. Sacrifice process |
| C. Yajurveda | 3. Medicine |
| D. Samaveda | 4. Music |

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 3 | 1 | 2 | 4 |
| (b) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (c) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows -

Atharvaveda	-	Medicine
Rigveda	-	God Grace
Yajurveda	-	Sacrifice process
Samaveda	-	Music

9. Match List-I with List- II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List- I

List- II

- | | |
|----------------|----------------------|
| A. Rigveda | 1. Musical hymns |
| B. Yajurveda | 2. Hymns and rituals |
| C. Samaveda | 3. Charms and spells |
| D. Atharvaveda | 4. Hymns and prayers |

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| | A | B | C | D |
| (a) | 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 |
| (b) | 3 | 2 | 4 | 1 |
| (c) | 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 |
| (d) | 2 | 3 | 1 | 4 |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

Rigveda consists of 1028 hymns and 10552 Verses or mantras or shlokas. Yajurveda contains the description of stotras and recitals. The Samaveda consists of many hymns which are taken from Rigveda and are indeed lyrical and melodious. The Atharvaveda contains a lot of knowledge of the physical world and spirituality.

10. Which one of the following four Vedas contains an account of magical charms and spells?

- (a) Rig Veda (b) Yajurveda
(c) Atharvaveda (d) Samaveda

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

The earliest description of charms and spells can be found in Atharvaveda.

11. In Rig Veda there are..... mantras –

- (a) 1028 (b) 1017
(c) 1128 (d) 1020

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

Rigveda consists of 1028 hymns and 10552 Verses (mantras)

12. The Rig Veda is the

- (a) Collection of hymns (b) Collection of stories
(c) Collection of words (d) Text of war

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The Rigveda is an ancient collection of Vedic Sanskrit hymns. It consists of thousands of such hymns of several seers, each hymn averaging around ten verses. It is one of the four canonical sacred texts (Shruti) of Hinduism known as 'Vedas.'

13. Match the List-I and List-II and choose your answer from the codes given below:

List-I	List-II
A. Rig Veda	i. Gopatha
B. Samaveda	ii. Shatpatha
C. Atharvaveda	iii. Aitariya
D. Yajurveda	iv. Panchvisha

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	iv	ii	iii	i
(b)	ii	iv	iii	i
(c)	iii	iv	i	ii
(d)	i	ii	iv	iii

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched order is :
Rigveda - Aitareya
Samaveda - Panchvisha
Atharvaveda - Gopatha
Yajurveda - Shatpatha, Taittiriya

14. Which one of the following Brahmana texts belongs to the Rigveda?

- (a) Aitareya Brahmana (b) Gopatha Brahmana
(c) Shatpatha Brahmana (d) Taittiriya Brahmana

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

15. Separate Brahmin texts were written for each Veda.

The Brahmin texts related to Yajurveda is:

- (a) Gopatha
(b) Panchvish and Jaiminiya
(c) Aitareya and Kaushitaki
(d) Taittiriya and Shatpatha

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

16. 'Gopatha Brahmana' is associated with –

- (a) Yajurveda (b) Samaveda
(c) Atharvaveda (d) Rigveda

U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The Gopatha Brahmana is the only Brahmana, a genre of prose texts describing the Vedic rituals, associated with the Atharvaveda. The text is associated with both the Shaunaka and the Paippalada recensions of the Atharvaveda.

17. Which of the following is a Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda?

- (a) Vajasanami (b) Maitrayani
(c) Taittiriya (d) Kathak

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

There are two branches of Yajurveda-Shukla Yajurveda and Krishna Yajurveda. Vajasneyi is the Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda. Shukla Yajurveda is available only in the poetic form whereas Krishna Yajurveda contains both poetic as well as prose form.

18. Which Mandala of Rig Veda is completely dedicated to 'Soma'?

- (a) Seventh Mandala (b) Eighth Mandala
(c) Ninth Mandala (d) Tenth Mandala

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

RigVeda is the oldest Veda. It comprises of 10 Mandals. The 9th Mandal of Rigveda comprises 114 hymns dedicated to 'Soma.'

19. The ninth mandala of the Rigveda is devoted wholly to:

- (a) Indra and his elephant
(b) Urvashi and the Heaven
(c) Gods related to plants and drugs
(d) 'Soma', the god who is named after the drink

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

20. Rights and Rituals related to Yajnas are mentioned in–

- (a) Rig Veda (b) Samaveda
(c) Brahmin Granthas (d) Yajurveda

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Yajurveda in Sanskrit means 'wisdom of sacrificial formulas.' This Veda, compiled a century or two after the Rig-veda, contains prose and verse formulae that were to be pronounced by the priests performing the manual part of the sacrifice. It describes in prose about the procedural details of performing different rituals and Yajnas using the hymns of the Rigveda. The Samhitas of Yajurveda are divided into two parts: Shukla or white Yajurveda and Krishna or black Yajurveda.

21. The compilation of which among the following is based upon the Rig Veda?

- (a) Yajurveda (b) Samaveda
(c) Atharvaveda (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The Samaveda is the shortest among all the four Vedas. It is closely connected with the Rigveda. It has taken many verses from the Rigveda. The Samaveda is compiled inclusively for ritual application and all of its verses are meant to be chanted in ceremonies. Samaveda Samhita consists a total of 1875 verses. Among these except 75 or 99 verses, all of them are compiled in Rigveda.

22. The earliest evidence of the use of iron in India has been discovered from :

- (a) Taxila (b) Atranjikhhera
(c) Kaushambi (d) Hastinapur

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Atranjikhhera is a prehistoric and historic excavated archaeological site on the bank of Kali river, a tributary of Ganga. This site was first identified by Sir Alexander Cunningham in his survey report in 1861-62 but excavated by R.C. Gaur. A Trial trench put in 1962, was followed in the next year by digging on a small scale. Regular excavation was started in 1964. The earliest evidence of iron used in the region dates back to around 1000 B.C.

23. When did the use of iron begin in Indian subcontinent?

- (a) Around 9000 years ago
(b) Around 12000 years ago
(c) Around 6000 years ago
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (e)

The history of early iron smelting, practised by the tribal artisans in different regions of ancient India dates back to 1300 to 1200 B.C. Most of the archaeologists accept around 1000 B.C. as the start of the Iron Age in subcontinent. So earliest use of iron in Indian subcontinent can be placed around 3000 years ago. Hence option (e) none of the above is correct.

24. Upanishads are books on –

- (a) Religion (b) Yoga
(c) Law (d) Philosophy

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (d)

The Upanishad literature is not a religious scripture but represents a philosophy for all times and for all. The philosophy of Upanishads does not oppose any school of thought, religion or interpretation of the scriptures, but its method for explaining its concepts is unique. Upanishad means pupils sit near the teacher to learn from him about the secret doctrine.

25. The main theme of Upanishads is –

- (a) Social structure (b) Philosophy
(c) Law (d) State

U.P.Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

26. Which one of the following Vedic literature talks about salvation :

- (a) Rig Veda (b) Later Samhitas
(c) Brahmins (d) Upanishads

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (d)

The word salvation or Moksha is not used in Vedas. It was first discussed in Upanishads. Moksha means 'liberation'. The continuous cycle of life and death is not the actual aim of the human soul. According to the Upanishads, the core of our self is not the body or the mind but the Atman (Soul).

27. The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the :

- (a) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
(b) Chhandogyan Upanishad
(c) Kathopanishad
(d) Kenopanishad

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

Kathopanishad is the story of the conversation between Yama, Lord of death and Nachiketa, the young 12 year old boy, who left home in search of the meaning of death and beyond. This forms the subject matter of one of the Upanishads called Katha Upanishad or Kathopanishad.

28. 'Nachiketa' legend finds mention in :

- (a) Atharvaveda
(b) Shatapatha Brahmin
(c) Kathopanishad
(d) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

29. King Asvapati of the Upanishadic period was the ruler of:

- (a) Kashi (b) Kekaya
(c) Panchala (d) Videha

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

The Upanishads state that some Kshatriya kings who were great scholars and philosophers also imparted knowledge to Brahmins. Some of them were- King Janak of Videha, King Pravahanjabali of Panchal, King Asvapati of Kekaya and King Ajatshatru of Kashi. Asvapati was a Kshatriya king. He was well known as a learned teacher of the age. The Kekaya kingdom was situated on the bank of river Beas, east of Gandhara kingdom. King Asvapati ruled Kekaya when Janak was the king of Videha.

30. Which of the following is the correct order of the Vedic literature?

- (a) Vedic Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads
(b) Vedic Samhitas, Upanishads, Aranyakas, Brahmanas
(c) Vedic Samhitas, Aranyakas, Brahmanas, Upanishads
(d) Vedic Samhitas, Vedangas, Aranyakas, Smritis

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Each of the Vedas is divided into four parts (or sections). The correct order of them is Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas and Upanishads. Samhitas and Brahmanas form the Karma-Kanda segment of the Vedas. Aranyakas and Upanishads form the Gyan-Kanda segment of the Vedas. They explicitly focus on philosophy and spirituality.

31. The river mentioned most in early Vedic literature is :

- (a) Sindhu (b) Shutudri
(c) Sarasvati (d) Ganga

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Sindhu river was the most important river during the Vedic period; that is why it was mentioned most of the time in the Rig Veda. Sindhu river due to its economic importance was called 'Hiranyayi' and its place of termination is in the 'Arabian Sea.' Saraswati river was the most pious river of Rigvedic Aryans and was called "Naditama".

32. Vedic river Askini is identified with which one of the following rivers?

- (a) Beas (b) Ravi
(c) Chenab (d) Jhelum

U.P. P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

Vedic river Askini is identified with a present-day river named as Chenab, also popularly known as Chandrabhaga. The river Chenab originates from Tandi in Lahul Spiti where two rivulets namely Chandra and Bhaga meet to form this river.

33. Which of the following rivers mentioned in the Rig Veda indicates the relations of Aryans with Afghanistan?

- (a) Askini (b) Parushni
(c) Kubha, Krumu (d) Vipasha, Shutudri

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Rivers mentioned in the Rig Veda namely Kubha (Kabul), Krumu (Kurram), Gomati (Gomal) and Suvastu (Swat) were flowing through Afghanistan which indicates that there were deep relations of Aryans with the country.

34. The Vedic river Kubha was located in:

- (a) Afghanistan (b) Chinese Turkistan
(c) Kashmir (d) Punjab

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

35. Match the List-I and List-II and choose the correct answer from the code given below:

List-I (Vedic Rivers)	List-II (Modern Name)
A. Kubha	1. Gandak
B. Parushni	2. Kabul
C. Sadaneera	3. Ravi
D. Shutudri	4. Sutlej

Code:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	4	3
(b)	2	3	1	4
(c)	3	4	2	1
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

Rivers given in the options are correctly matched as follows with their modern names –

(Vedic Rivers)	(Modern name)
Kubha	- Kabul
Parushni	- Ravi
Sadaneera	- Gandak
Shutudri	- Sutlej

36. In the period of Mahabharata, the name of Mahanadi was

- (a) Kaveri (b) Tapti
(c) Mahananda (d) Ganga
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

The name of Mahanadi during the period of Mahabharata was 'Chitrotpala'. In the Bhishma Parv of Mahabharata, the Chitrotpala river is praised as Punayadayini and Paap (sin) Nashini. Indian people drank the water of Chitrotpala. This fact is proved by the following Verse of Mahabharata – "चित्रोत्पला चित्ररथां मंजुलां वाहिनीं तथा। मंदाकिनीं वैतरणीं कोषां चापि महानदीम्॥"

The Mahanadi has been called Chitrotpala Ganga in the Mahoba copper plate of Someshwar Dev.

37. As per the Vayu Puran, what is the mythological name of Mahanadi river?

- (a) Chitrotpala (b) Nilotapala
(c) Kanak Nandini (d) Mahananda

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

In Vayu Puran the Mythological name of Mahanadi river is Nilotapala. In Matsya Puran river Mahanadi was stated as Chitrotpala.

38. Which of the followings customs emerged during the post-Vedic period :

- (a) Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha
(b) Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra
(c) Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa
(d) Indra, Surya, Rudra, Maruta

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a & c)

According to ancient Hindu scriptures, during the Post-Vedic period, the 'Hindu' tradition recognized four stages or Ashramas in human life, namely-Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha and Sanyasa and four Purusharth namely-Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha.

39. While living in which Ashram did a person have to perform the rituals of the Pancha Mahayagya?

- (a) Brahmacharya Ashram
(b) Grihastha Ashram
(c) Vanaprastha Ashram
(d) Sannyasa Ashram

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (b)

While living in the Grihastha Ashram (householder stage), a person was required to perform the Pancha Mahayajnas (Five Great Sacrifices). These five sacrifices were: Brahma Yajna, Deva Yajna, Pitra Yajna, Bhuta Yajna, Atithi Yajna. The Grihastha Ashram was considered the foundation of society, as it was during this stage that a person earned wealth and also supported the other three ashramas—Brahmacharya, Vanaprastha and Sanyasa.

40. The 'Dharma' and 'Rita' depict a central idea of ancient Vedic Civilization of India. In this context , consider the following statements :

1. 'Dharma' was a conception of obligations and the discharge of one's duties to oneself and to others.
2. 'Rita' was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Dharma and Rita in the Vedic period appear as early as the Rigveda. Usually, Dharma signifies cosmic ordinance often in connection with the sense of natural or divine law. 'Rita' as such is closely related to universal harmony in which all things in the world have a proper place and function. So the term 'Rita' means an impersonal law while Dharma characterizes those personal actions that engender or maintain the cosmic order. Thus, the correct answer is option (c).

41. In context on Indian culture 'Rita' means

- (a) Natural law (b) Artificial law
(c) Human law (d) Social law
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The concept of 'Rita' i.e., the universal principle of natural order, is of Vedic origin. The 'Rita' has been the basis of Indian culture, legal theory, politics and philosophy. God Varuna was supposed to uphold 'Rita' or the natural order which is why he was also called as 'Ritasyagopa'.

42. Who among the following Vedic deities was believed to be their priest ?

- (a) Agni (b) Brihaspati
(c) Dyaus (d) Indra

U.P.P.C.S. (Main) 2013

Ans. (b)

Brihaspati also known as Deva-guru (teacher or priest of Gods), is the guru of the Devas (Gods).

43. Who among the following was a Brahnavadini who composed some hymns of the Vedas?

- (a) Lopamudra (b) Gargi
(c) Leelavati (d) Savitri

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Many hymns of the Rigveda were composed by women and they were called Brahnavadini. The prominent amongst them were Lopamudra, Vishwawara, Sikta, Nivavari and Ghosa. Lopamudra was the wife of Agastya Rishi/Sage.

44. During the Rigvedic Period word 'Nishka' was used for a Jewellery but in later periods it was used for the meaning of :

(a) Arms (b) Farming equipment
(c) Script (d) Coin

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

During Rigvedic period, the gold necklace was called as 'Nishka-Griva' but later on word Nishka got associated with the gold coins.

45. During the Rigvedic period Nishka was an ornament of—
(a) Ear (b) Neck
(c) Arm (d) Wrist

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

46. 'Nishka' in ancient India was known as —

(a) Gold Ornament (b) Cows
(c) Copper Coins (d) Silver Coins

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

47. Boghaz-Koi is important because:

(a) It was an important trading centre between Central Asia and Tibet
(b) Inscriptions were found which mentioned the names of Vedic Gods and Goddesses
(c) Original Texts of the Vedas were composed here
(d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Boghaz-Koi inscription (Asia Minor, Turkiye) is important because there is mention of four Vedic Gods, namely-Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatya.

48. Which of the following inscriptions tells about the Aryan's movement of Aryans from Iran to India ?

(a) Man Sehra (b) Shahbazgarhi
(c) Boghaz-Koi (d) Junagarh

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

49. An inscription of 14th century B.C. which describes the Vedic Gods has been found in

(a) Ecbatana (b) Boghaz-Koi
(c) Babylon (d) Bisotun

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Boghaz-Koi inscription which mentions four Vedic Gods namely-Indra, Varuna, Mitra and Nasatya is a 14th century B.C. inscription.

50. Who among the following wrote on the original homeland of the Aryans?

(a) Sankaracharya (b) Annie Besant
(c) Vivekanand (d) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Bal Gangadhar Tilak in his book 'The Arctic Home in the Vedas' propounded the theory that the North Pole (Arctic region) was the original home of Aryans. But this theory of Tilak is not acceptable to historians.

51. The name of scripture in which 'Purusha Medha' was mentioned is:

(a) Krishna Yajurveda (b) Shukla Yajurveda
(c) Shatpath Brahmana (d) Panchvish Brahmana

U.P. P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (*)

'Purusha Medha' has been mentioned in Shatpatha Brahmana of Shukla Yajurveda and Taittiriya Brahmana of Krishna Yajurveda. No answer can be given all three are present in the given options. However many historians discuss Purushmedh Yajna while discussing Shatpatha Brahmana only.

52. The priest associated with King Videgha Madhava referred in Shatpatha Brahmana was —

(a) Rishi Bharadwaj
(b) Rishi Vashishta
(c) Rishi Vishwamitra
(d) Rishi Gautama Rahugana

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

It is believed that Saraswati was the scene of the activities of the famous Vedic tribes - the Bharatas, the Purus, and the Kurus. The Shatpatha Brahmana narrates the story of King Videgha Madhava (a king of Videha) accompanied by his priest Rishi Gautama Rahugana, carrying the sacred fire to the east preserving thereby the tradition that the Kosalas and the Videhas received from their culture.

53. In the post-Vedic period which was considered as the axis of Aryan Culture

- (a) Anga, Magadha (b) Kosal, Videha
(c) Kuru, Panchala (d) Matsya, Shurasena

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

In the post-Vedic period, this region of Kuru, Panchala was considered as the axis of Aryan culture because here great achievements happened in science, mathematics, astronomy, religion and philosophy.

54. The word Gotra occurs for the first time in

- (a) Atharvaveda (b) Rigveda
(c) Samaveda (d) Yajurveda

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

As a Rigvedic term, gotra simply means "cow shelter" or "herd of cows". The specific meaning "family lineage kin" (as it were "herd within an enclosure") is relatively more recent, first recorded around post-Vedic period.

55. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of

- (a) Bhakti
(b) Image worship and yajnas
(c) Worship of nature and yajnas
(d) Worship of nature and bhakti

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The religion of early Vedic Aryans was mainly related to worship of the nature and performing of Yajnas. The Aryans in the early Vedic period described life as a manifestation of nature. Worship of different forces of nature formed a part of their religious belief. They believed that some divine power works behind the objects of nature such as fire, water, wind etc.

56. In the Rigvedic period, people believed mainly in –

- (a) Idol worship (b) One God belief
(c) Goddess worship (d) Sacrifice and rituals

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

Sacrifice or Yajna was the central feature of Rigvedic religion. Domestic sacrifice was the general rule. Community sacrifices offered by kings were grand festivals. It was believed that Gods were pleased by Yajna or sacrifice.

57. Famous Battle of 'Ten Kings' was fought on the bank of the river –

- (a) The Ganges (b) Brahmaputra
(c) Kaveri (d) Parushni

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

There is an ancient story mentioned in the Rigveda called the Dasharajnya or 'Battle of 10 Kings' on the bank of Parushni River. There lived a descendant of India's eponymous king Bharata, named Sudas. The greatest achievement of Sudas was his thumping victory over a confederacy of ten kings.

58. The famous battle of 'Ten Kings' as described in the Rig Veda was fought on the bank of

- (a) Parushni (b) Saraswati
(c) Vipasa (d) Asikni

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

59. Which of the following rivers among the following referred as 'Matetama', 'Devitama' and 'Naditama' in the Rig Veda?

- (a) Sindhu (b) Saraswati
(c) Vitasta (d) Yamuna

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

Saraswati River was considered as the most pious and respected river during the Rigvedic period. In the Rigveda, Saraswati is referred as 'Matetama,' 'Devitama' and 'Naditama' means best of all mothers, best of all Goddesses and the best of all rivers respectively.

60. Give the name of the tribe which is not related to the 'Panchjana' of the Rigveda Aryans:

- (a) Yadu (b) Puru
(c) Turvasu (d) Kikat

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

Pancha-Jana suggested five specific tribes whose eponymous ancestors were the founders of the clans, namely Yadu, Turvasu, Druhyu, Anu and Puru. Kikat was not among them.

61. In the ancient period chief-livelihood source of the Aryans was –

- (a) Agriculture (b) Hunting
(c) Artcraft (d) Business

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

In ancient times, the Aryans were dependent on Agriculture and hunting for their livelihood.

62. The word 'Yava' mentioned in Rigveda is used for which agricultural product ?

- (a) Barley (b) Gram
(c) Rice (d) Wheat

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

The word 'Yava' mentioned in Rigveda is used for the food grain barley. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

63. Match list-I with list-II and choose the correct answer from the code given below –

List-I	List-II
A. Vrihi	(i) Sugarcane
B. Mudga	(ii) Rice
C. Yava	(iii) Mung bean
D. Ikshu	(iv) Millet

Code –

- (a) A-(i), B-(ii), C-(iii), D-(iv)
 (b) A-(iv), B-(iii), C-(ii), D-(i)
 (c) A-(iii), B-(iv), C-(i), D-(ii)
 (d) A-(ii), B-(iii), C-(iv), D-(i)

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows –

Vrihi – Rice
 Mudga – Mung bean
 Yava – Millet
 Ikshu – Sugarcane

64. The Rigvedic "Pani" belonged to which class of citizens?

- (a) Priests (b) Ironsmiths
 (c) Goldsmiths (d) Traders

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

"Pani" during the Rigvedic period was a class of traders.

65. The System of Governance prevalent in the Vedic era was–

- (a) Autocratic (b) Democratic
 (c) Republic (d) Descended monarchy

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

The most popular and prevalent system of governance during the Vedic era was descended monarchy. Although some examples of election by the people were also found but the general interest of the public was towards monarchy.

66. 'Sabha' of Vedic-era –

- (a) Was an institution of mercantile people of the villages
 (b) Was a royal court
 (c) Was a council of ministers
 (d) National Assembly of all the people of the state

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

During the Vedic era, the two institutions namely 'Sabha' and 'Samiti' have been mentioned as the controlling powers upon the autocracy of the king. The 'Sabha' was the assembly of the learned and elite ones, while the 'Samiti' was the assembly of the common people in the state.

67. In which of the Vedas, Sabha and Samiti are called as two daughters of Prajapati ?

- (a) Rigveda (b) Samveda
 (c) Yajurveda (d) Atharvaveda

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (d)

The clear distinction between Sabha and Samiti cannot be made but it is clear that 'Sabha' and 'Samiti' were clearly mentioned in the Atharvaveda as the two daughters of Prajapati.

68. In which Veda are Sabha and Samiti declared as separate institutions?

- (a) Rigveda (b) Samaveda
 (c) Atharvaveda (d) Yajurveda

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

Among the Vedic texts, Sabha and Samiti are clearly mentioned as separate institutions in the Atharvaveda, although both these institutions (Sabha and Samiti) are also mentioned in the Rigveda. In the tenth Mandal of the Rigveda too, Sabha and Samiti are mentioned and an appeal is made to create unity and consensus between the two. In the Rigveda, the roles of Sabha and Samiti are not clearly separated nor are they established in an institutional form, as we find in the Atharvaveda. In a verse of the Atharvaveda, Sabha and Samiti are shown as two separate institutions and they are called 'two daughters of Prajapati'. Therefore, by mentioning them as two separate institutions in the Atharvaveda, their social and political importance is underlined.

69. The Rigvedic tribal assembly associated with judicial function was

- (a) Sabha (b) Samiti
 (c) Vidhata (d) All of these

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Several tribal or Clan-based assemblies such as the Sabha, Samiti, Vidhata are mentioned in the Rigveda. Among them Sabha was associated with the judicial function. Sabha is mentioned eight times in Rigveda. Sabha and Samiti are mentioned as two daughters of Prajapati in Atharvaveda.

70. Which officer was known as 'Bhagadugha' during Vedic administration?

- (a) Chief Officer of the Gambling Department
 (b) Revenue Collector
 (c) Messenger
 (d) Chief Officer of Forests

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Bhagadugha was associated with revenue administration in Vedic administration.

71. 'Ayurveda' that is 'Science of Life' appeared first in :

- (a) Aranyaka (b) Samveda
(c) Yajurveda (d) Atharvaveda

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

'Ayurveda' that is 'Science of Life' appeared first in Atharvaveda. Ayurveda is an Upaveda of Atharva Veda. It describes the thoughts and superstitions of common people. It comprises of various contents such as disease prevention, coordination, loyalty, marriage and love poetry.

72. Rig-vedic religion was—

- (a) Polytheistic (b) Monotheistic
(c) Monistic (d) Libertarian

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

The most interesting aspect of Rig Vedic religion was its polytheistic character in which a number of Gods were worshipped. The Rigvedic Aryans worshipped nature with intense feelings and endowed it with an animated soul. Vedic Gods were mainly classified into three groups- (1) God of sky-Varuna, Mitra, Surya, Vishnu, etc. (2) God of space- Indra, Rudra, etc. (3) God of the earth- Agni, Brihaspati, Soma, etc. Whenever these Vedic saints worship any God, they consider him to be the Supreme God, this is known as Ekaikyavaad. Other than this in Rigveda Ekeshwarvaad is supported by saying Ekam Satt Vipra bahudha badanti". Ekeshwarvaad of Rigveda included vision of Advaityavaad, Sarvadevtavaad and Bahudevataavaad. But the concept of one supreme God of Vedas is different from the modern Ishwarvaad.

73. The largest number of Rigvedic hymns are devoted to:

- (a) Agni (b) Indra
(c) Rudra (d) Vishnu

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

Ans. (b)

'Indra' has been described as the most powerful deity in the Rigveda. 'Indra' is the most important divinity in the Rigveda. A very large number of Rigveda hymns (as many as 250 hymns) are devoted to him followed by 'Agni' (200 hymns).

74. Who among the following is regarded as War-God in the Rig Veda ?

- (a) Agni (b) Indra
(c) Surya (d) Varuna

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

In the Rigveda, a maximum number of hymns are devoted to the God 'Indra'. He was the Storm-God and referred to as the Sky-God and the God of War. The Vedas describe Indra as the God who wields the thunderbolt.

75. The largest hymn of Rigveda is dedicated to which Vedic god?

- (a) Agni (b) Indra
(c) Varuna (d) Aditya

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

76. The largest number of the Hymns in Rig Veda belongs to—

- (a) Agni (b) Varuna
(c) Vishnu (d) Yama

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

The largest number of hymns in Rigveda belongs to god Indra. But in the present question, in the absence of the Indra we choose Agni (Second largest).

77. Study the following statements about the Vedic God Indra and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

1. Was the God of thunder.
2. Punished the sinners.
3. Was the guardian of the moral order.
4. Was the God of rain.

Codes :

- (a) 1 and 2 are correct. (b) 1 and 3 are correct.
(c) 2 and 4 are correct. (d) 1 and 4 are correct.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

In Vedas, Indra is the King and the Dev of Svarga (Heaven). He is the God of heaven, lightning, thunder and rain. Guardian of the moral order (Rita) was lord Varuna. Some hymns, are prayers to God Indra for punishing the sinners, but in the absence of option 1, 2 and 4 we choose 1 and 4.

78. Who among the following was the most popular God of the early Vedic Aryans ?

- (a) Varuna (b) Vishnu
(c) Rudra (d) Indra

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

79. Who of the following Gods was considered as War-God in the Vedic literature?

- (a) Varuna (b) Indra
(c) Agni (d) Mitra

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

80. 800 B.C. to 600 B.C. is related to which era?

- (a) Brahmin era (b) Sutra era
(c) Ramayana era (d) Mahabharata era

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

800 B.C. to 600 B.C. is related to Brahmin era. Often period during seventh century B.C. or sixth century B.C. to third century B.C. is called as Sutra Period.

81. Gayatri Mantra is found in which book?

- (a) Upanishad (b) Bhagwadgita
(c) Rig Veda (d) Yajurveda

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The Gayatri Mantra was first written in Sanskrit in the Rig Veda by the Brahmarshi Vishwamitra. Its meaning is "May the Almighty God illuminate our intellect to lead us along the righteous path."

82. The 'Mantra' famous with the name of 'Gayatri Mantra' found in which of the following scriptures –

- (a) Bhagwat Gita (b) Atharvaveda
(c) Rig Veda (d) Manusmriti

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

83. Who composed the Gayatri Mantra?

- (a) Vasishtha (b) Vishwamitra
(c) Indra (d) Parikshit

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

84. There was a provision for reciting which mantra in the Upanayana ritual of the Kshatriya castes?

- (a) Jagati Mantra (b) Gayatri Mantra
(c) Sarvesham Mantra (d) Trishtubh Mantra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

During the Upanayana ceremony of the Kshatriya caste, the Trishtubh Mantra was prescribed. It symbolized the martial and heroic qualities associated with Kshatriyas, aligning with their warrior duties and societal responsibilities in Vedic tradition.

85. Sarga, Pratisarga, Vansa, Manvantara and Vanshanucharita are the indicators of -

- (a) Vedas (b) Puranas
(c) Upanishads (d) Sutras

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015

Ans. (b)

Puranas have five characteristics Sarga, Pratisarga, Vansa, Manvantara and Vanshanucharita. Among these, Sarga and Pratisarga are the natural creation and renovation (cosmogony). Vansa means the history of Sage and God. Manvantara is meant for the period of different Manus and Vanshanucharita means Genealogy of kings.

86. The number of Puranas is–

- (a) 16 (b) 18
(c) 19 (d) 21

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

Puranas are the sacred literature of Hinduism. There are 18 Puranas namely, (1) Matsya Purana (2) Markandeya Purana (3) Bhagavat Purana (4) Bhavishya Purana (5) Brahmanda Purana (6) Brahma Vaivrata Purana (7) Brahma Purana (8) Vamana Purana (9) Varaha Purana (10) Vishnu Purana (11) Vayu Purana (12) Agni Purana (13) Narada Purana (14) Padma Purana (15) Linga Purana (16) Garuda Purana (17) Skanda Purana (18) Kurma Purana. Out of these 18 Puranas, Srimad Bhagvatam is considered as the 'Crown Jewel' of all the Vedic literature.

87. Consider the following statements:

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

A parable is a short and simple story that teaches a religious or moral lesson. The Upanishads contain several parables and stories that are used to explain philosophical concepts and teachings. For example, the parable of the two birds mentioned in the Kathopanishad, and also in the Mundaka and Svetasvatara Upanishads, unfolds many nuances about the jivatma who is essentially a unique blend of the human and the divine. Hence, statement 1 is incorrect. The Upanishads, which form the philosophical part of the Vedic literature, were composed mainly during the later Vedic period, while the Puranas were composed much later, starting around the early centuries of the common era. Hence, statement 2 is correct.

88. With reference to the Puranas, which one of the following statements is/are correct?

- (1) Information about the Mauryan dynasty is found in the Vishnu Purana.
- (2) Vayu Purana throws light on the Gupta's governance system.

- (a) Only 1 (b) Neither 1 nor 2
(c) Only 2 (d) Both 1 and 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The Vishnu Purana gives an account of Mauryan Dynasty. Vayu Purana is related to Gupta Dynasty and Matsya Purana is related to Andhra Satavahana Dynasty.

89. In which language was the 'Shrimad Bhagavad Gita' originally written ?

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Urdu
(c) Pali (d) Hindi

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

Shrimad Bhagavad Gita was originally written in the Sanskrit language often referred in short as Gita. There are 700 verses in this Hindu scripture and this is the part of the epic Mahabharata.

90. Originally the Mahabharata was known as –

- (a) Brihatkatha (b) Brahmins
(c) Brihatsamhita (d) Jayasamhita

U.P.R.O/A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Mahabharata originally had only 8,800 shlokas and its original name was 'Jaya' or Jayasamhita. Mahabharata today has 100,000 Shlokas and is believed to be written by Sage Veda Vyasa.

91. The Shatasahasri-Samhita is the nickname of which of the following texts?

- (a) Rigveda (b) Atharvaveda
(c) Ramayana (d) Mahabharata

U.P.B.E.O. (Pre.) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

92. According to Hindu mythology, which serpent offered himself as a rope for churning the ocean?

- (a) Kalia (b) Vasuki
(c) Pushkar (d) Sheshnag

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

The churning of the ocean of milk (Ksira Sagar) was an elaborate process. Mount Mandara or Mandar Parvat was used as the churning rod and Vasuki, the king of serpents who abides on Shiva's neck, became the churning rope. Lord Vishnu, in the form of Kurma Avtar, came to their rescue and supported the mountain on his back.

93. In which phase, the concept of untouchability was put clearly?

- (a) Rigvedic phase (b) Later Vedic phase
(c) Later Gupta phase (d) Dharmashastra phase

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

The concept of untouchability assumed definite shape in the early Christian era which was the period known as the era of Dharmashastra in ancient Indian history. During this period, the Brahmanical religion was in ascendance. Various scriptures were being written and the social customs of different types were practised strictly and untouchability was one of them.

94. From which Upanishad, the words "Satyameva Jayate" have been taken?

- (a) Mundakopanishad (b) Kathopnishad
(c) Chhandogyanishad (d) None of these

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

The word "Satyameva Jayate" is a Sanskrit word taken from the 'Mundakopanishad'. The meaning of the word is "truth alone triumphs." It was adopted as the national motto of India. It is inscribed in the script at the base of the national emblem. On January 26, 1950, it was adopted by the Government of India.

95. From where was word 'Satyameva Jayate' taken?

- (a) Manusmriti (b) Bhagavadgita
(c) Rig Veda (d) Mundakopanishad

I.A.S. (Pre) 2004

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1992, 1994

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

96. 'Satyamev Jayate', which is engraved on the Indian Emblem, has been taken from –

- (a) Rig Veda (b) Bhagavad Gita
(c) Mundakopanishad (d) Matsya Purana

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

97. The statement "Tamsoma Jyotirgamaya" was originally mentioned in

- (a) Upanishadas (b) Mahakavyas
(c) Puranas (d) Shaddarshanas
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The statement "Tamsoma Jyotirgamaya" is originally mentioned in Brihadaranyaka Upanishada. This statement means - "lead us from darkness to light or lead us from ignorance to truth"

98. In which Upanishad is the famous dialogue of Yagnavalkya and Gargi mentioned?

- (a) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
(b) Taittiriya Upanishad
(c) Aitareya Upanishad
(d) Prashnopanishad

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (a)

The dialogue between Yagnavalkya and Gargi is mentioned in the Brihadaranyaka Upanishad.

99. The literal meaning of which Upanishad is white horse?
 (a) Kathopanishad (b) Chhandogya Upanishad
 (c) Taaittiriya Upanishad (d) Eshopanishad
 (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (e)

None of the Upanishads in the given options literally means 'white horse'. Shvetashvatara Upanishad is an ancient Sanskrit text embedded in the Yajurveda. Shvetashvatara literally means 'carried on a white horse'.

100. The legend of Satyakam Jabal, which challenges the stigma of being an unmarried mother, is mentioned in -
 (a) Jabal Upanishad (b) Prashnophishad
 (c) Chhandogya Upanishad (d) Kathopanishad

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Satyakama Jabala as a boy, and later a Vedic sage, who first appears in chapter IV of ancient Hindu text, the Chhandogya Upanishad challenged the stigma of an unmarried mother.

101. Fundamental or basic script of the 'Rig Veda' was -
 (a) Devnagri (b) Kharoshthi
 (c) Pali (d) Brahmi

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (d)

The basic script of the Rig Veda was Brahmi. The work on a script or 'Bhasa' is said to have been started by Brahma. For thousands of years, the script was known after him as the Brahmi script. The Rig Veda is divided into 10 Mandals, which consist of 1028 Sukta and 10552 Mantra. According to Patanjali, there are 21 branches of Rig Veda. The priests of Rig Veda were called 'Hota'.

102. In the Vedic rituals HOTA is associated with the-

- (a) Rig Veda (b) Yajurveda
 (c) Samaveda (d) Atharvaveda

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

103. There is a similarity in Avesta and the Rig Veda, from which region the Avesta is related to -

- (a) India (b) Iran
 (c) Israel (d) Egypt

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

According to a definition given about the Aryans: The Indo-Iranian group whose members composed the Zoroastrian scriptures, the Avesta and the Hindu scriptures such as the Vedas, called themselves Aryans. So it is clear that in the Vedic period it was the region of present-day Iran, where Zoroastrianism prevailed, and the 'Avesta' was written by Zoroastrians.

104. Which of the following animals was considered as "Aghanya" during the Vedic period:-

- (a) Bull (b) Sheep
 (c) Cow (d) Elephant

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

It was the cow which was considered as "Aghanya" during the Vedic period. "Aghanya" means not worthy of being killed. This status of the cow shows how pious it was considered during the Vedic period.

105. Aghanya in Rig Veda is mentioned for -

- (a) Goat (b) Cow
 (c) Elephant (d) Horse

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

106. The name 'Aghanya' mentioned in many passages of the Rig Veda refers to :

- (a) Priest (b) Women
 (c) Cows (d) Brahmanas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

107. With reference to the difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus Valley people, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus Valley Civilization did not leave any evidence of using them.
2. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus Valley people knew only copper and iron.
3. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus Valley people having been aware of this animal.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
 (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

A coat of mail and helmet made of gold and iron is mentioned in Rigveda. Possibly they were used in warfare. Indus Valley people were lacking in weapons and were possibly ruled by a class of merchants. Indus Valley civilization did not leave any evidence of using weapons. Therefore, statement 1 is correct. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper. Indus Valley people knew only copper and bronze. The use of iron spread in North India between 1000 BC - 600 BC. Therefore, statement 2 is wrong. Rigvedic Aryans owed their success in India to their use of horses and chariots and